

Page 3 — Three Worked Examples by Tier

One Recruiter example, one HRBP Manager example, one CHRO example — the whole chain from activity through working relationship, readiness, governance, and final transition recommendation, run against live PCF 7.0 data and presented as a stage check against each rule, citing the term used at every step.

GiGi asked for this specifically: "one Recruiter example, one HRBP Manager example, and one CHRO example. Show the whole chain from activity through working relationship, readiness, governance, and final transition recommendation." One example per role tier — Operational, Managerial, Executive — chosen to test whether the chain holds up across seniority levels, not just across different kinds of risk (that's what the separate five-activity pressure test was for).

Live source: docs/sandbox/pcf7.html and docs/role_taxonomy.html. Each stage below cites the specific rubric or rule it's checked against — Page 1 (Human Readiness Gate), Page 2 (Human Criticality Review), or one of the two rules below — rather than asserting a result.

Rules Referenced

Two rules do real work in this chain and are already in use, but haven't had a citable form until now. Both are transcribed here verbatim from their source, not re-derived.

Progression Ceiling Rule — governs the Working Relationship stage

Applied to every one of the 90-plus non-individually-walked activities in the live PCF 7.0 dataset:

1. Automation is always the floor. Current State = Automation → Future = Ceiling = Automation, always.

2. A standing accountability duty makes Judgment the ceiling. Strategic authority, EEOC/adverse-impact liability, ERISA fiduciary duty, NLRA/union exposure, or confidentiality/duty-of-care → already at the top; Future = Ceiling = Judgment.

3. Everything between (Agent-delegation / Augmentation / Oversight): if the item's note flags a standing duty attached to that specific tier, that tier is the ceiling — Future = Ceiling = Current. If no such duty is flagged, the ceiling moves one notch more automated.

Source: inline comment above WR_DATA in docs/sandbox/pcf7.html, "a disclosed heuristic... offered as Claude's own perspective for Tim and GiGi to spot-check and override."

Governed Decision Point definition — governs the Governance Limit stage

Every Governed Decision Point needs to include:

• Owner — who is named Accountable

- **Escalation** — a specific trigger and destination when the owner can't resolve it
- **Override** — a defined path to reverse or block an AI-proposed action
- **Documentation** — a record of what happened and why
- **Review** — a cadence for revisiting the decision or the assignment itself

Source: GiGi Garcia, HITL Working Thoughts & Next Steps, Section 4.

OPERATIONAL

Recruiter — Negotiate Offer

PCF 7.2.4.2

Pattern: Decision · RACI (7.2.4 Manage new hire/re-hire): A: Recruiter · R: Comp & Benefits Mgr (offer terms) · C: Director of TA · I: HRIS Analyst

STAGE 1 Working Relationship — checked against the Progression Ceiling Rule

Current: **Judgment** · Future: **Judgment** · Ceiling: **Judgment**. Rule 2 applies: compensation-negotiation authority combined with pay-equity/compensation-discrimination exposure functions as a standing duty at this tier.

FLAG, NOT FAIL — Judgment ceiling confirmed, but this is an Operational-tier role (Recruiter) holding a Judgment-ceiling activity, atypical elsewhere in this domain where Judgment sits almost entirely with Managerial/Executive roles. Worth carrying into the readiness check below rather than treating as settled.

STAGE 2 Human Criticality Review — checked against Page 2's six questions

Human impact	Directly affects the candidate's comp outcome; can affect internal pay equity at the margin.
Legal/regulatory	Yes — pay-equity and compensation-discrimination exposure attach directly to negotiation decisions.
Financial/operational	Direct and immediate — comp above band, signing bonus, relocation are real dollar commitments.
Trust/reputation	Internal equity-perception risk if terms aren't applied consistently; limited external exposure.
Reach	Narrow per instance (one hire), though the pattern across many hires can compound into systemic exposure.
Reversibility	Low — walking back an accepted offer damages trust and can carry its own legal exposure.

HIGH — direct legal exposure and poor reversibility, but reach is narrow per instance, which is why this lands at High rather than Critical. Matches the live tag.

STAGE 3 Human Readiness Gate — checked against Page 1's eight dimensions, for Recruiter (Accountable)

Authority	ADEQUATE	Real within standard parameters, but the activity's own trigger hands final authority to Comp & Benefits Manager past a threshold.
Information	ADEQUATE	Has candidate-side context; relies on Comp & Benefits Manager for band/market data.
Capability	ADEQUATE	Trained for standard negotiations; the escalation trigger exists precisely because capability tops out below the exception threshold.
Capacity	STRONG	High-frequency, routine-volume work, well within normal load.
Role clarity	STRONG	The existing Governed Decision Point is unusually explicit about where Recruiter's authority ends.
Confidence	ADEQUATE	Reasonable within standard parameters; untested against an AI-drafted negotiation position specifically.
Psychological safety	STRONG	No indication of penalty risk for escalating an exception.

Escalation / override	STRONG	Already has a named, trigger-conditioned path to Director of Talent Acquisition — more precise than any other activity checked so far.
GATE PASSES — 4 Strong, 4 Adequate, 0 Weak. No dimension fails outright, but four of eight are bounded rather than fully strong, consistent with this being a shared-authority activity.		

STAGE 4 Governance Limit — checked against the Governed Decision Point definition		
Owner	✓	Recruiter, bounded — already named.
Escalation	✓	Director of Talent Acquisition, with a specific named trigger.
Override	IMPLICIT	Bundled into the escalation trigger, not separately named.
Documentation	✗	Not required by the current entry.
Review	✗	No cadence specified.
3 of 5 elements explicit — this is the one example where governance machinery already exists rather than needing to be proposed from scratch.		

STAGE 5 Transition Recommendation — synthesis, not a separate check		
Hold at Judgment. The chain confirms the existing governance design is basically sound — this is the example that shows the governance layer already working as intended for a bounded-authority case. Intervention: add explicit Override and Review terms to the existing Governed Decision Point entry, since Authority and Confidence both read Adequate rather than Strong above.		

MANAGERIAL

HRBP Manager — Manage Leave of Absence

PCF 7.6.2.2

Pattern: Transaction · RACI (7.6.2 Manage separation): A: HRBP Manager · R: HR Generalist · C: Compensation & Benefits Manager · I: Legal*

STAGE 1 Working Relationship — checked against the Progression Ceiling Rule		
Current: Automation · Future: Automation · Ceiling: Automation. Live note: "routine execution, but FMLA/ADA interference exposure if leave administration is mishandled."		
OPEN QUESTION — Rule 1 applies mechanically ("Automation is always the floor... always"), with no carve-out for standing regulatory duty the way Rule 3 has for higher tiers. The note flags real FMLA/ADA exposure sitting on an Automation-tier activity. Proceeding with the live classification as tagged, but this is a real gap in the rule as written, worth raising with Tim and GiGi directly rather than silently resolving it here.		

STAGE 2 Human Criticality Review — checked against Page 2's six questions	
Human impact	Direct — job-protected leave status, benefits continuity, and return-to-work rights are at stake.
Legal/regulatory	Yes, specifically named — FMLA and ADA interference claims are a well-established litigation category.
Financial/operational	Moderate direct cost; litigation cost if mishandled is significant.
Trust/reputation	Real internal trust impact — leave failures are exactly the story that damages standing with the workforce.
Reach	Narrow per instance (one employee on leave), though volume can be substantial org-wide.
Reversibility	Mixed — routine errors are correctable, but an interference finding tied to an adverse action can be very hard to unwind.
HIGH — matches the live tag. Not Critical: the exposure is well-precedented and defensible when procedure is followed, unlike, for example, the grievance activity's NLRB/CBA exposure with less procedural containment.	

STAGE 3 Human Readiness Gate — checked against Page 1's eight dimensions, for HRBP Manager (Accountable)		
Authority	STRONG	Clear authority to intervene in a leave case.
Information	ADEQUATE	Case-level visibility, but FMLA/ADA determinations often need legal nuance beyond standard case data.
Capability	WEAK	FMLA/ADA interaction analysis is specialist legal-adjacent judgment; the role is staffed for a largely-automated process, not this expertise on every case.
Capacity	STRONG	Routine-volume, automated — capacity isn't the constraint.
Role clarity	ADEQUATE	Accountable per RACI, but no defined point at which an automated case should be pulled out for direct attention.
Confidence	WEAK	Same root cause as Capability — not well positioned to challenge an automated system's edge-case handling.
Psychological safety	ADEQUATE	No evidence of penalty risk, but also no established norm for pulling cases out of automation — untested rather than confirmed.
Escalation / override	WEAK	Legal is only Informed, not Consulted, despite the note's own FMLA/ADA language. No defined trigger for routing a case to Legal before action is taken.
GATE FAILS — 2 Strong, 3 Adequate, 3 Weak. An Automation-tier, High-consequence activity where readiness to catch exceptions is genuinely weak on the dimensions that matter most: Capability, Confidence, Escalation/override.		

STAGE 4 Governance Limit — checked against the Governed Decision Point definition		
Owner	✓	HRBP Manager, named.
Escalation	✗	No defined trigger comparable to the Recruiter example's "comp above band" — nothing tells the process when a case needs to stop for review.
Override	✗	Not defined.
Documentation	✗	Not defined.
Review	✗	Not defined.
1 of 5 elements explicit. Also a second, independent finding: Legal sitting at Informed despite a risk note arguing for Consulted is the same RACI pattern already found once on the grievance activity in the five-activity pressure test — now found twice, which raises it from an isolated note to a pattern worth a standing rule.		

STAGE 5 Transition Recommendation — synthesis, not a separate check		
Hold at Automation for routine processing — the base classification is right for volume reasons — but the ceiling is not closed. Interventions: (1) define a Governed Decision Point for the exception path — Owner: HRBP Manager, Escalation: a named trigger such as "leave nearing exhaustion combined with a performance action, or any ADA accommodation request," Override: Legal review before any adverse action during or immediately after protected leave, Documentation: a case-level record of why an exception was or wasn't escalated, Review: tied to any FMLA/ADA-adjacent incident rather than a fixed calendar; (2) upgrade Legal from Informed to Consulted here — the same correction flagged once already, now recommended as a standing rule rather than a one-off fix; (3) raise the open question from Stage 1 with Tim and GiGi directly: does the Progression Ceiling Rule need a duty carve-out at the Automation tier, the way it already has one higher up?		

EXECUTIVE

CHRO — Define HR Roles and Accountability

PCF 7.1.1.2

Pattern: Knowledge · RACI (7.1.1 Develop human resources strategy): A: CHRO · R: HRBP Manager · Director of HR Ops · C: Director of TA · I: All Managerial-tier

STAGE 1 Working Relationship — checked against the Progression Ceiling Rule		
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Current: **Judgment** · Future: **Judgment** · Ceiling: **Judgment**. Rule 2 applies directly: strategic authority over the domain's own accountability structure is a standing duty at the top of the ladder. Live note: "defining the domain's own accountability structure isn't a decision to hand to an AI proposal."

PASS — clean application of Rule 2, no open question.

STAGE 2 Human Criticality Review — checked against Page 2's six questions

Human impact	Indirect but broad — a wrong structure creates duplicated or missing ownership across HR, affecting employees through broken downstream processes.
Legal/regulatory	Indirect — a bad structure can itself create compliance gaps downstream (e.g. no clear EEOC-reporting owner), but this activity isn't itself a filing.
Financial/operational	High — restructuring accountability affects every downstream process in the domain.
Trust/reputation	Internal trust impact if roles are unclear or contested; limited external exposure.
Reach	Enterprise-wide — defines the domain's structure, touching every HR role.
Reversibility	Correctable but costly — re-organizing accountability is disruptive and slow to unwind once operationalized.

HIGH — matches the live tag. Not Critical: no direct or immediate harm to a specific individual, no acute legal filing at stake — the exposure is structural and slow-building rather than sharp.

STAGE 3 Human Readiness Gate — checked against Page 1's eight dimensions, for CHRO (Accountable)

Authority	STRONG	Top executive in the domain; full authority over any AI-drafted structural proposal.
Information	STRONG	Full visibility across the HR function.
Capability	STRONG	Defining organizational accountability structures is core to the role.
Capacity	ADEQUATE	Infrequent, high-effort work — a real but manageable constraint, not a failure since it doesn't compete with daily volume.
Role clarity	STRONG	RACI is unambiguous: CHRO Accountable, HRBP Manager/Director of HR Ops Responsible, Director of TA Consulted.
Confidence	STRONG	No reason to doubt the ability to challenge an AI-drafted structure proposal.
Psychological safety	STRONG	Top of the org — no penalty risk for overriding a proposal.
Escalation / override	STRONG	Escalates only to CEO/Board — a confirmed, non-provisional line per the live role-taxonomy table.

GATE PASSES CLEANLY — 7 Strong, 1 Adequate, 0 Weak. Secondary note: Responsible includes HRBP Manager, whose own reportsTo edge is one of the two the taxonomy flags as unconfirmed — but since HRBP Manager is Responsible here, not Accountable, this doesn't undermine the Accountable role's own readiness.

STAGE 4 Governance Limit — checked against the Governed Decision Point definition

Owner	✗	CHRO is clearly the de facto owner, but this activity is not currently registered as a Governed Decision Point on the live Move-to-Exit-style VSP pages the way 7.2.4.2, 7.3.3.4, and 7.6.1 are.
Escalation	✓	CEO/Board, confirmed.
Override	✓	CEO/Board.
Documentation	✗	Not currently required or defined for this specific activity.
Review	✗	Not currently defined.

2 of 5 elements explicit — not because readiness or authority is in question (Stage 3 passed cleanly), but because nobody has formally registered this as a Governed Decision Point at all.

Hold at Judgment. Cleanest of the three tier examples — readiness passes on 7 of 8 dimensions with the eighth merely Adequate, and governance isn't the binding constraint. **Intervention:** formally register this as a Governed Decision Point with documented rationale retained for any accountability-structure change and review tied to actual organizational-change events, since it currently has real authority behind it but no paper trail.

Where the Chain Held, Where It Didn't

Across the three tiers, the Working Relationship stage held up well — two clean Rule 2 applications (Recruiter, CHRO) and one genuine open question about whether Rule 1 needs the same duty carve-out Rule 3 already has (HRBP Manager). Readiness is where the three diverge sharply: CHRO passes cleanly, Recruiter passes on a bounded-but-functioning governance design, and HRBP Manager fails outright — not because Automation was the wrong base classification, but because nothing catches the exception cases the activity's own note already warns about. The Legal-at-Informed pattern also reappeared independently, now confirmed twice across two unrelated exercises, which is the kind of repeat finding that argues for a standing rule rather than a case-by-case fix.

A person can be named Accountable and still not be able to exercise that accountability — three tiers, and it only failed once, but it failed on exactly the dimensions the framework couldn't have caught without walking the chain.

Tim King & GiGi Garcia | Working Discussion Draft | September 2026

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Private review area — not part of the published framework

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